

KUN LEE

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Tony Atkinson Fellow, LIS Cross-National Data Center; Research Associate, Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER)	2024-Present
Research Affiliate, Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI), University of Oxford, UK	2025-2026
Visiting Researcher, Institute for Social Development and Policy Research, Seoul National University, Republic of Korea	August 2025

EDUCATION

DPhil Social Policy, University of Oxford, UK	2020-2024
<i>Supervisors:</i> Bernhard Ebbinghaus, Marek Naczyk	
<i>Examiners:</i> Michaela Kreyenfeld, Kenneth Nelson, Erzsébet Bukodi	
MSc Comparative Social Policy (<i>Distinction</i>), University of Oxford, UK	2018-2019
BA Social Welfare & Economics (<i>Summa Cum Laude</i>), Seoul National University, Republic of Korea	2012-2018

Visiting Research & Exchange

Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA (4 months, Host: Fabian Pfeffer)	2024
Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, Finland (1 month, Host: Kati Kuitto)	2023
Humboldt University of Berlin, Germany (3 months, Host: Anette Fasang)	2023
University of Mannheim, Germany (4 months, Host: Bernhard Ebbinghaus)	2022
University College London, UK (Arts & Sciences, Undergraduate Exchange)	2016-2017

PUBLICATIONS*Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles* (* Corresponding author)

Lee, K. (2026). 'Old and new welfare states retaining older workers in the face of crisis: The case of COVID-19 in Europe', *Socio-Economic Review* (online first)

Lee, K. & Ebbinghaus, B. (2026). 'Converging or unequal retirement patterns? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany over three decades of cohorts', *Social Forces*, 105(1): 54-76.

Oh, J., Son, S. & **Lee, K.*** (2025). 'Exclusion from a 'mandatory' pension scheme: Late-stage dropouts from the National Pension System in South Korea', *Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 100578.

Kim, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'Intra-couple allocation of paid and unpaid work, allocation

perceptions, and life satisfaction in South Korea: An analysis based on the ‘equitable specialization’ framework’, *Korean Journal of Social Welfare*, 77(2): 213-237 [in Korean]

Lee, K. (2024). ‘Varying Effects of Public Pensions: Pension Spending and Old-age Employment under Different Pension Regimes.’ *Journal of European Social Policy*, 34(1).

- JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize 2023 (Best Paper)

- SASE 2023 Early Career Workshop Award

Lee, K. (2022). ‘Old-age Poverty in a Pension Latecomer: The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions in South Korea’, *Social Policy & Administration*, 56(7): 1022-1040.

Lee, K. & Zaidi, A. (2020). ‘How policy configurations matter: a critical look into pro-natal policy in South Korea based on a gender and family framework’, *International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy*, 40(7/8): 589-606.

Book Chapters

Kuitto, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). ‘How to make extending working lives in ageing welfare states socially sustainable’, in M. Vaalavuo, K. Nelson & K. Kuitto (eds.), *Social Sustainability in Ageing Welfare States*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Ebbinghaus, B. & **Lee, K.** (2023). ‘From early retirement to later exit from work: shifting towards active ageing’, in D. Clegg & N. Durazzi (eds.), *Handbook of Labour Market Policy in Advanced Democracies*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Working Papers

‘Threats of AI? Workers’ perceptions of technological change and precautionary saving behaviour’ (w/ Ludivine Martin & Thuc Uyen Nguyen-Thi), *Revise & Resubmit*

‘Beyond Beveridge and Bismarck: Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st century’ (w/ Daria Frost & Bernhard Ebbinghaus), *Revise & Resubmit*

‘Socio-economic differences in life expectancy and inequalities in pension and retirement’, chapter under contract, *The Oxford Handbook of Aging and Social Policy*

‘A fragile social contract: The politics of an unpopular pension reform in South Korea’ (w/ Dong-kyun Im), *Revise & Resubmit*

‘A Slow Convergence? Intra-couple Division of Labor and Subjective Well-being in South Korea, 2004-2024’ (w/ Keon Kim), *accepted for a special issue contribution*

‘Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age’ (w/ Javier Olivera & Philippe Van Kerm), *under review*

‘Beyond average effects: The role of family policies in shaping fertility and women’s labour force participation across policy types and regimes’ (w/ Eunho Cha & Stacie Tao), *under review*

AWARDS, GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Social Policy Association Travel Grant [GBP 425]	2025
KFAS-Salzburg Global Fellowship	2024
SustAgeable Consortium Grant, Helsinki, Finland [EUR 1,500]	2023

Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Doctoral Dissertation Grant [USD 7,500]	2023
JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize (Best Paper)	2023
SASE Early Career Workshop Award [USD 2,000]	2023
German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Short-term Grant [EUR 3,850]	2022
ICPSR Summer Program Scholarship for Public Administration, Public Policy, and Public Affairs, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA [USD 2,600]	2022
Centenary Scholarship, DSPI, University of Oxford, UK [GBP 85,000]	2020
Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (KFAS) Doctoral Fellowship [USD 100,000]	2020
Republic of Korea Government Scholarship for Study Overseas [GBP 26,700]	2018

TEACHING

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK

Social Policy (Undergraduate) – <i>Seminar Leader</i>	Fall 2023; 2021-2022
Quantitative Analysis (Postgraduate) – <i>Teaching Assistant</i>	Fall 2023
Training for Advanced Teaching & Learning, Higher Education Academy (UK Professional Standards Framework)	Winter/Spring 2022

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany

Reform Dynamics in European Welfare States (Undergraduate) – <i>Co-Instructor</i> (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus)	Spring 2023
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INVITED LECTURES

‘(Macro-)Panel Data Analysis using LIS data’, *LIS Summer Workshop*, Luxembourg, July 2026

‘Analyzing Panel Data in Comparative Research’, Guest lectures

- *Governance and Global Affairs Methods Lab*, Leiden University the Hague, Netherlands, 19 February 2026
- *Comparative Research Methods*, University of Mannheim, Germany, November 2022

‘Panel Data Analysis using LIS data’, *LIS Summer Workshop*, Luxembourg, July 2025

‘The Luxembourg Income and Wealth Study: Introduction and Applications to Comparative Inequality Research’, Special Lecture at the Annual Symposium of the *Korean Inequality Research Network*, Seoul, Korea, 16 July 2025

‘Introduction to the South Korean Pension System: History, Current State and Challenges’, *ETK Research Seminar*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, 4 October 2023

SEMINARS/WORKSHOPS

‘The politics of an unpopular pension reform: Evidence from two survey experiments in South Korea’, *Policy & Politics Workshop*, Leiden University, Netherlands, 26 March 2026

‘Still Beveridge or Bismarck? Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st Century’, *European Symposium on Policy Modelling*, Luxembourg, 25 March 2026’

‘Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age’

- *ETK Pension Research Forum*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, 16 March 2026
- *(LIS)²ER-SHARE Workshop: Pensions and Old-age Well-being*, 27-28 November 2025
- *CBS Seminar*, Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp, 15 May 2025

‘Threats of AI? How workers perceive and respond to technological change in the workplace’

- *East Asian Political Economy Workshop*, King’s College London, 26 June 2025
- *Netspar International Pension Workshop*, Leiden, 18 June 2025

‘Convergence or continued stratification? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany’

- *Sequence Analysis Association Webinar Series*, 17 October 2024 (online)
- *LISER Seminar Series*, Luxembourg, 7 November 2024

‘Socio-demographic differences in older workers’ job loss in the early phase of the pandemic’, *ESPAnet Germany PhD Workshop*, WZB Berlin, 16-17 March 2023

‘The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions on Older People’s Income and Poverty in South Korea’, *BSA Social Statistics Group Brown Bag* (online), 30 September 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (* Poster)

Annual ESPAnet Conference (ISEG Lisbon, Portugal); World Inequality Conference (Paris School of Economics, France); PAA Annual Meeting (St. Louis, MO, USA); In_equality Conference (University of Konstanz, Germany); Winter School on Inequality and Social Welfare Theory (University of Verona, Canazei, Italy)	2026
ISI Wealth Inequality Conference (LMU Munich, Germany); READI Annual Meeting (Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea); SPA Annual Conference (University of York, UK); PAA Annual Meeting (Washington DC, USA); ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting (University of Milan, Italy); Comparative Economic Inequality Conference (Luxembourg)	2025
Annual ESPAnet Conference (Tampere University, Finland); EASP-FISS Joint Conference (Kyoto, Japan); PAA Annual Meeting* (Columbus, OH, USA)	2024
Annual ESPAnet Conference (University of Warsaw, Poland); ISA-RC28 Summer Meeting* (University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA); SASE Annual Conference (Rio de Janeiro, Brazil); SPA Annual Conference (University of Nottingham, UK); ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting (Sciences Po, Paris, France)	2023
ESA-RN26 Mid-term Conference (Berlin, Germany); Annual ESPAnet Conference (University of Vienna, Austria); FISS Annual Conference (Sigtuna, Sweden)	2022
Annual ESPAnet Conference (online); BSA Work, Employment & Society Meeting (online); EASP-FISS Joint Annual Conference (online)	2021
East Asian Social Policy Annual Conference (National Taiwan University, Taipei)	2019

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Journal Referee: Ageing & Society; Applied Economics; Applied Economics Letters; Asian

Social Work & Policy Review; Economic Modeling; International Journal of Social Welfare; International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy; Humanities & Social Science Communications; Journal of Aging & Social Policy; Journal of Asian Public Policy; Journal of Economic Inequality; Journal of the Economics of Ageing; Journal of Governmental Studies; Journal of Population Ageing; Nature Scientific Data; Poverty & Public Policy; Review of the Economics of Household; Social Policy & Administration; Social Science Research; Socius

Core Member, Pensions Policy Research Group, Social Policy Association UK, 2023-Present

Main Organizer, (LIS)²ER Visiting Program & Seminar Series, 2024-2026

Organizing Committee, (LIS)²ER-SHARE Luxembourg Joint Workshop: “Pensions and Old-age Well-being: Policy Challenges in Ageing Societies”, 27-28 November 2025

Organizing Committee, 5th (LIS)²ER Workshop: “Fighting Poverty: Measurement and Policy Challenges”, 11-13 December 2024

Organizing Committee, Symposium for Early Researchers in Social Policy & Intervention, Nuffield College, Oxford, 27 May 2022

Co-chair, Young Scholar Session: Labour market and social policy responses to the pandemic, The COVID-19 Public Health and Social Measures (PHSMs) Conference, 6 October 2021

ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

‘A Slow Convergence? Intra-couple Division of Labour and Related Perceptions in South Korea, 2004–2024’, *LIS Newsletter*, Issue No. 38, June 2026

‘How pension systems (re)shape the landscape of wealth inequality and redistribution’, *LIS Newsletter*, Issue No. 37, March 2026

2nd KFAS-Salzburg Global Leadership Initiative: Technology, Growth & Inequality, 2024-25

Contributions to Oxford Supertracker: A global database for COVID-19 policy trackers

Organizing Committee, Oxford-Korea Forum, Wolfson College, Oxford, 12 November 2021

‘Myths and Truths of the South Korean National Pension’, *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 1 December 2023

‘Changes in European Countries’, in Sang-jin Han (ed.), *An International Comparative Study on Citizen Participatory Governance Model and Health and Welfare Policies in the COVID-19 Era*, Policy Report for the Ministry of Health and Welfare, Republic of Korea

‘Europe’s Policy Responses to the Labour Market Crisis during the Pandemic’, *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 21 October 2021

Treasurer, Oxford Korean Academic Society, University of Oxford, 2020-21

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Oxford, UK	2021
Research Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2021
Research Assistant, King’s College London, UK	2020

Curriculum Vitae

July 2026

Administrative Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2019-2020
IARU Global Intern, Oxford Institute of Population Ageing, Oxford, UK	2019
Social Work Trainee, Hanwoori Rehabilitation Center, Seoul, Korea	2018
Military Service, National Assembly Police Officer, Seoul, Korea	2014-2015

OTHER SKILLS

Languages: English (fluent), Korean (native)

Statistical Software: R, Stata